

UNIVERSIDADE REGIONAL DE BLUMENAU
DEPARTAMENTO DE LETRAS

REFLECTIVE PORTFOLIO

*Perspectives and Critical Analyses on
Academic Writing*



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Opening Text

Introduction

This portfolio intends to provide a general view of my experience and reflections upon the Academic Writing class taught by professor Cyntia Bailer. It should be a source of information about the class, its materials and ideas that were brought to me with it. Besides a collection of topics from the class, it will contain my personal observations and thoughts about what we've learned during class.

Who Am I?

I am Gustavo Guerreiro, a computer science (CS) student at FURB. I am already at the end of the course. All mandatory subjects are done. Now I just need to work on the final project and get some elective courses from other courses. However, I am going for a double diploma in the University of Jade in Germany, so I have to briefly pause my undergraduate studies on the specific area and study subjects such as Academic Writing and "Direito Civil - Parte Geral" in order to prepare for my studies over there.

I consider myself to be a curious and multidisciplinary person. I usually like to read and learn about topics outside my CS degree like philosophy, theology and mathematics (of course, such studies are not formal in any way, shape, or form, I just cherry pick the topics that interest me the most and read about them).

Expectations

This course interests me quite a bit. It is a new way of thinking, talking about writing structures and techniques, maybe a bit of neurology and philosophy of language excites me. I am always up for learning how to improve myself, and writing is such an important part of expression. It makes me look forward to the classes.

I have little background both on writing long English texts and writing academic texts in general. Although I am familiar with the day-to-day use of the language through my job, I hope to learn more about the language, its structure, and improve my capacity of providing arguments and writing clearly in this language.

Chapter 1

March

March 2nd

The class started with the story "Malala's Magic Pencil". The story was about how Malala was a girl that liked to draw and study, and after noticing the problems of Pakistan she started to dream about helping to solve the problems of her people like war and extremism. The story ended showing how her writings were important in bringing worldwide attention to the situation of her people.

I believe the professor chose the story to represent the importance of proper writing and how powerful good texts can be. This relates to the current subject of good academic writing, because good academic productions can provide small advancements to human knowledge and science as a whole. Therefore like Malala's writing, good academic writing can provide change and contribute to a better world, even though only by a small amount. After the story there was a round of quick introductions among classmates, and then we discussed the course plan, go-

ing through the evaluation process and the topics that will be covered by the classes.

It seems the classes will be interesting. After all there will be a good emphasis on how different English is from Portuguese writing-wise, beyond only translations, but the logic itself, especially when dealing with summaries.

The idea of improving my writing and seeing this language that feels so familiar to me through new lenses excites me. Judging by the reading of the children's book, I believe that we will read quite a bit and get familiar with different texts and learn good argumentation and sentence writing in the language in a highly technical and objective perspective.

